4.**Project planning phases for Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer**

Phase 1: Project Initiation

Identify the problems in the existing IT procurement process.

Understand the difficulties in manually ordering laptops.

Define the project objectives and scope.

Identify the stakeholders, such as employees, IT teams, and procurement teams.

Define the expected outcomes of automation.

Objective: To automate standard laptop ordering and reduce manual work.

Phase 2: Requirement Gathering and Analysis

Collect requirements from employees and the IT procurement team.

Identify standard laptop models available for ordering.

Define the laptop request form fields.

Identify approval requirements.

Define the conditions for approving or rejecting requests.

Requirements:

Employee details

Laptop model

Business justification

Manager approval

Procurement notification

Order status tracking

Phase 3: Process Design

Design the laptop request workflow.

Create a request form in ServiceNow.

Define the approval process.

Plan automated notifications.

Design the workflow for approved and rejected requests.

Workflow:

Employee submits request → Manager approval → IT/Procurement processing → Order confirmation → Employee notification.

Phase 4: Development and Automation

Configure the required request form in ServiceNow.

Create a flow using Flow Designer.

Configure the trigger when a laptop request is submitted.

Add approval actions.

Configure conditional logic for approved and rejected requests.

Set up email notifications.

Update the request status automatically.

Objective: To automate the laptop procurement workflow using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

Phase 5: Testing and Validation

Test the laptop request submission process.

Verify manager approval functionality.

Test approved and rejected scenarios.

Verify automated email notifications.

Check whether request statuses update correctly.

Fix errors identified during testing.

Expected Result: The workflow should operate correctly for all defined scenarios.

Phase 6: Deployment and Implementation

Deploy the completed workflow to the appropriate environment.

Verify the configuration.

Provide basic instructions to employees and procurement staff.

Monitor the workflow after implementation.

Resolve any issues that occur during deployment.

Objective: To implement the automated procurement process successfully.

Phase 7: Monitoring and Maintenance

Monitor the workflow performance.

Track the number of laptop requests processed.

Identify workflow failures.

Update the workflow when business requirements change.

Collect feedback from employees and the procurement team.

Make improvements based on feedback.

Objective: To ensure the automated process remains reliable and efficient.

Expected Project Outcomes

Reduced manual work.

Faster laptop request processing.

Improved approval tracking.

Automated notifications.

Better visibility into procurement requests.

Reduced processing errors.

Improved efficiency of IT procurement.

Conclusion: This project uses ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate standard laptop orders. The seven phases cover the project lifecycle, from initial planning to ongoing maintenance, helping streamline the procurement process and improve operational efficiency.